ECONOMY AND INTEREST RATES BRIEF

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Poland: growth, inflation, rates and the zloty, and what they mean for a furniture exporter

Poland · 2026-11-13

Prepared for **Vistula Furniture Sp. z o.o. (fictional)** · 2026-11-13 · Levente Frigyes
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FICTIONAL SAMPLE · ALL COMPANY DATA IN THIS DOCUMENT IS INVENTED FOR DEMONSTRATION

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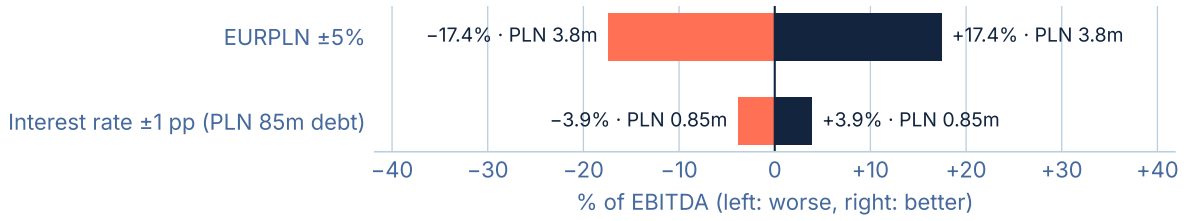
PLN 3.8m
RESULT CHANGE IF EURPLN MOVES 5%
= 17.4% of EBITDA; a weaker EUR lowers the result

PLN 4.8m
INTEREST ON FLOATING DEBT, A YEAR
85m at 5.64% all-in

PLN 0.85m
EXTRA INTEREST PER 1 PP RISE
= 3.9% of EBITDA

4.38
EURPLN TODAY (OCT 2026)
5-year average 4.42 · +3.1% on a year

What moves the annual result: share of EBITDA



BOTTOM LINE

The exchange rate weighs most on the result: a 5% EURPLN move changes it by PLN 3.8m (17.4% of EBITDA), 4.5x the effect of a 1 pp rate move; a 12-month move of 5% or more happened in 14% of cases in the last ten years. Interest costs PLN 4.8m a year; EBITDA covers it 4.6x today and 3.4x after a 2 pp rate rise.

KEY POINTS

- **The zloty matters more than interest rates.** A 5% move in EURPLN changes the annual result by PLN 3.8m (17.4% of EBITDA); a 1 pp rate move changes interest by PLN 0.85m (3.9%). The budget should state its EURPLN assumption and show the result at plus and minus 5%.
- **EURPLN is 4.38, close to its five-year average of 4.42** (+3.1% on a year). It has moved 3.1% a year on average over the last three years.
- **Floating debt costs about PLN 4.8m a year** at today's WIBOR of 3.84% (−0.91 pp on a year). That is 0.24 pp above the latest full-year inflation (2025, IMF).
- **Long-term rates have risen:** the 10-year yield is 6.23%, higher than in 94% of the last ten years' months, and 2.39 pp above the 3-month rate.
- **The IMF expects growth of 3.4% in 2026 and 2.5% in 2027,** with inflation of 3.2% and 2.8%: steady demand at home, so export prices and the zloty remain the main swing factors.

Where the indicators stand

INDICATOR	UNIT	LATEST	PERIOD	ON THE YEAR	VS 5-YEAR AVG	10-YEAR RANK	3-MONTH TREND
Real GDP growth	% a year	3.70	2025	+0.50 pp	−0.20 pp	–	–
Inflation (CPI)	% a year	3.60	2025	0.00 pp	−4.02 pp	–	–
Unemployment rate	%	3.10	2025	+0.20 pp	+0.08 pp	–	–
EURPLN exchange rate	PLN per EUR	4.38	Oct 2026	+3.1%	−0.9%	61%	Flat
10-year government yield	% a year	6.23	Sep 2026	+0.76 pp	+0.67 pp	94%	Rising
3-month interbank rate (WIBOR)	% a year	3.84	Sep 2026	−0.91 pp	−1.56 pp	57%	Flat

Source: [S1] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31; [S2] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31; [S3] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31; [S4] European Central Bank, data to 2026-10-01; [S5] FRED, data to 2026-09-01; [S6] FRED, data to 2026-09-01 · full references at the end

10-year rank: share of the last ten years' months at or below the latest value (near the maximum = the highest level in ten years). 3-month trend: the last three months against the three before (Flat within ±2%, or ±0.1 pp for rates). Annual figures are the IMF's.

How rates and the exchange rate reach the result

Floating-rate debt reprices with the reference rate, so each 1 pp move changes annual interest by PLN 0.85m (3.9% of EBITDA). Net EUR revenue of 17,500k a year is converted at the market rate; a 5% move changes its value by PLN 3.8m, which is why the exchange rate is the largest sensitivity.

Real GDP growth: why it matters and where it stands

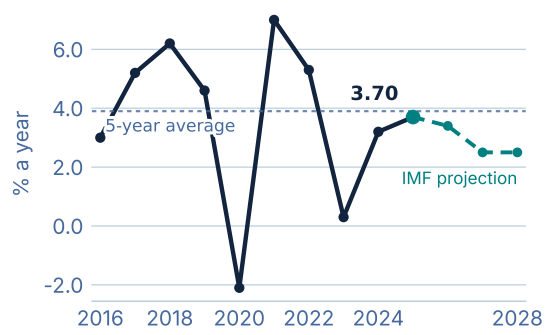
Growth drives domestic demand and wages, and so the company's zloty cost base. Today 3.70%, against a five-year average of 3.90 and a five-year range of 0.30 to 7.00.

Inflation (CPI): why it matters and where it stands

Inflation drives wage claims and the central bank's rate decisions. Today 3.60%, against a five-year average of 7.62 and a five-year range of 3.60 to 14.40.

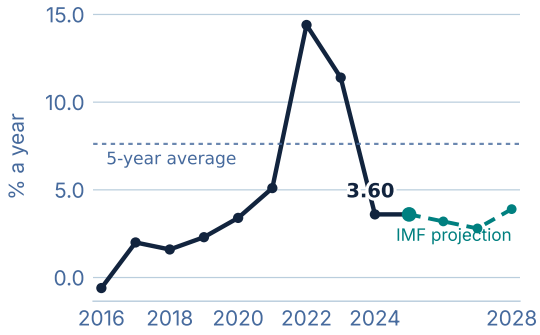
The indicators over time

Real GDP growth (% a year)



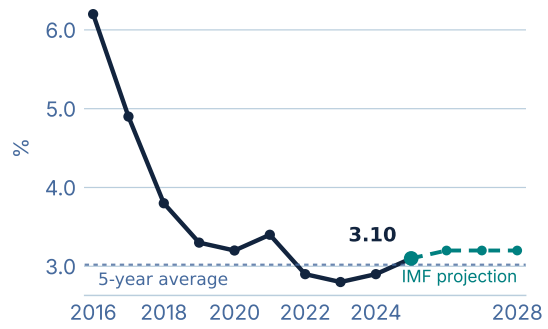
Source: [S1] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31 · full references at the end

Inflation (CPI) (% a year)



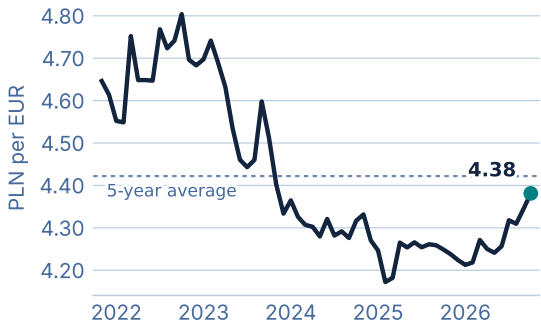
Source: [S2] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31 · full references at the end

Unemployment rate (%)



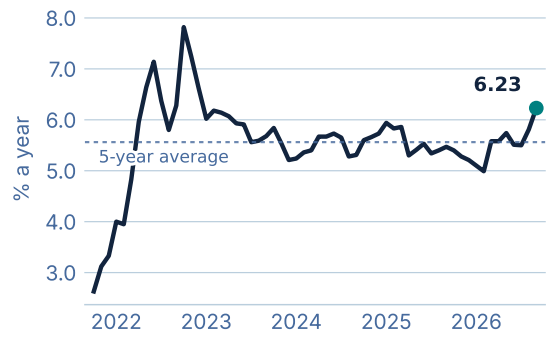
Source: [S3] International Monetary Fund, data to 2025-12-31 · full references at the end

EURPLN exchange rate (PLN per EUR)



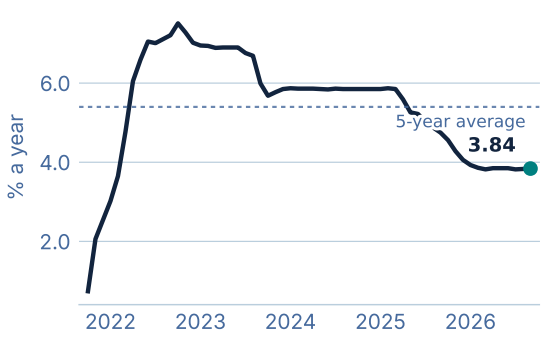
Source: [S4] European Central Bank, data to 2026-10-01 · full references at the end

10-year government yield (% a year)



Source: [S5] FRED, data to 2026-09-01 · full references at the end

3-month interbank rate (WIBOR) (% a year)



Source: [S6] FRED, data to 2026-09-01 · full references at the end

Unemployment rate: why it matters and where it stands

A tight labour market means stronger wage pressure for manufacturers. Today 3.10%, against a five-year average of 3.02 and a five-year range of 2.80 to 3.40.

What it means for the company's result

The company has PLN 85m of floating-rate debt and net EUR revenues of 17,500k a year (PLN 76.7m at the latest rate). The figures below are the arithmetic effect of rate and exchange-rate moves on the annual result; negative means worse. The yield curve slope (10-year minus 3-month) is 2.39 pp. The 3-month rate minus the latest annual inflation (the real rate) is +0.24 pp.

Sensitivity of the annual result

MOVE	RESULT, WORSE SIDE	RESULT, BETTER SIDE	WORSE SIDE, % OF EBITDA	HOW OFTEN IN 10 YEARS
EURPLN ±5%	−PLN 3.8m	+PLN 3.8m	−17.4%	14%
Interest rate ±1 pp	−PLN 0.85m	+PLN 0.85m	−3.9%	42%

How often in 10 years: share of the last ten years' 12-month periods in which the indicator moved at least this much, in either direction. It shows how ordinary a move of this size is; it is not a probability for the next year.

Debt and interest cover

MEASURE	TODAY	RATE +1 PP	RATE +2 PP
Floating-rate debt / EBITDA	3.9x	–	–
Interest a year	PLN 4.79m	PLN 5.64m	PLN 6.49m
Interest cover (EBITDA / interest)	4.6x	3.9x	3.4x

Compare the cover with the minimum in the company's loan agreements; the covenant levels are not part of this brief.

Drivers to watch

- National Bank of Poland rate decisions and inflation releases from Statistics Poland
- Euro-area demand for furniture and the EURPLN rate, which set the zloty value of export revenue
- Government borrowing needs, which drive the long-term yield
- Wage growth, which drives the company's zloty cost base

Decisions this brief supports

- The interest and exchange-rate assumptions in the 2027 budget
- The headroom in bank covenants for a rate or currency move
- Pricing of euro-denominated export contracts

EURPLN exchange rate: why it matters and where it stands

EURPLN converts the company's euro export revenue into zloty: a stronger zloty lowers it. Today 4.38 PLN per EUR, against a five-year average of 4.42 and a five-year range of 4.17 to 4.80. Only 39% of the last ten years' months were higher. It typically moves 3% in a year.

10-year government yield: why it matters and where it stands

The 10-year yield sets the price of long-term and fixed-rate borrowing. Today 6.23%, against a five-year average of 5.56 and a five-year range of 2.63 to 7.82. Only 6% of the last ten years' months were higher.

Sources

[S1] International Monetary Fund, World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) · Poland: real GDP growth (IMF WEO, with projections) (NGDP_RPCH/POL) · 2025-12-31 · https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/NGDP_RPCH/POL · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/NGDP_RPCH/POL

[S2] International Monetary Fund, World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) · Poland: consumer-price inflation (IMF WEO, with projections) (PCPIPCH/POL) · 2025-12-31 · https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/PCPIPCH/POL · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/PCPIPCH/POL

[S3] International Monetary Fund, World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) · Poland: unemployment rate (IMF WEO) (LUR/POL) · 2025-12-31 · https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/LUR/POL · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/api/v1/LUR/POL

[S4] European Central Bank, Data Portal (SDMX) · EURPLN exchange rate (ECB, monthly average) (EXR/M.PLN.EUR.SP00.A) · 2026-10-01 · https://data-api.ecb.europa.eu/service/data/EXR/M.PLN.EUR.SP00.A?format=csvdata · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://data.ecb.europa.eu/data/datasets/EXR

[S5] FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis · Poland: 10-year government yield (OECD) (IRLTLT01PLM156N) · 2026-09-01 · https://fred.stlouisfed.org/graph/fredgraph.csv?id=IRLTLT01PLM156N · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/IRLTLT01PLM156N

[S6] FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis · Poland: 3-month interbank rate (OECD) (IR3TIB01PLM156N) · 2026-09-01 · https://fred.stlouisfed.org/graph/fredgraph.csv?id=IR3TIB01PLM156N · accessed 2026-11-13 · series page: https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/IR3TIB01PLM156N

Method and definitions

How to read this brief. Every figure is public data (numbered sources above, with the date downloaded), arithmetic on the company's own inputs (marked as client input), or an official projection labelled as such. Statistics use monthly averages; rates change in percentage points (pp), prices in percent.

Definitions. 10-year rank: the share of the last ten years' months at or below today's level (near the maximum = a ten-year high). vs 5-year average: how far today's level is from the average of the last five years. 3-month trend: the last three months against the three before (Flat within ±2%, or ±0.1 pp for rates). Volatility: the typical yearly swing, from monthly changes over the last three years. How often in 10 years: the share of all 12-month periods in the last ten years in which the indicator moved at least this much; it describes the past, not a probability.

About the data. Monthly prices and rates are published with a delay of one to two months, so the latest month shown is the latest month available on the report date. Statistical offices revise recent figures; quarterly and annual series are shown as published. Exchange rates are ECB reference rates; commodity prices are IMF primary commodity prices; annual growth, inflation and unemployment figures and their projections are the IMF's, which updates them in April and October.

Scope. Rate and currency risk management is outside the scope of this brief; discuss it with the company's bank.

Important information

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